

Congestion cost €770m, 3.4% of GDP?

The Malta Chamber's figure, traced to the government's transport plan

THE CLAIM

“...traffic congestion imposed an estimated cost of €770 million on the Maltese economy, equivalent to 3.4% of GDP.”

The Malta Chamber of Commerce, Enterprise and Industry, LEAD proposals, 14 May 2026

Footnote: Transport Master Plan 2030, page 124.

The government's plan gives the figure but no calculation for 2025.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*Cited correctly, but no method;
3.4% is 3.1% of 2025 GDP.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

€770m

The government's figure

National Transport Master Plan 2030: “up from €770 million in 2025”. No derivation is published.

3.1%

Share of 2025 GDP

€770m against €24.7bn GDP at current prices. 3.4% would need GDP of €22.6bn.

€917m

The plan's 2030 projection

If nothing changes. Environmental costs (€195m a year) come on top of both figures.

€248m

Lost time, 2030, in the annex

The only costing we found models 2030 and 2060, not 2025, and does not show how €917m is built up.

€1.13bn

Another estimate

Engineer Marco Cremona (reported 3 June 2026) put it higher; we have not read his method first-hand.

FAIR TO SAY

The Chamber reported the government's own figure accurately and gave the page. A large cost is plausible; it is not yet testable.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Ministry for Transport: the method for €770m.

☐ Ministry: hours lost and values of time used.

☐ Malta Chamber: the GDP figure behind 3.4%.

☐ Publication of the plan's traffic model report.